

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, some sun, increasing clouds, light winds, high 67. **Tonight**, mostly cloudy, low 49. **Tomorrow**, cloudy, a late-afternoon shower, light breeze, high 62. Weather map, Page B8.

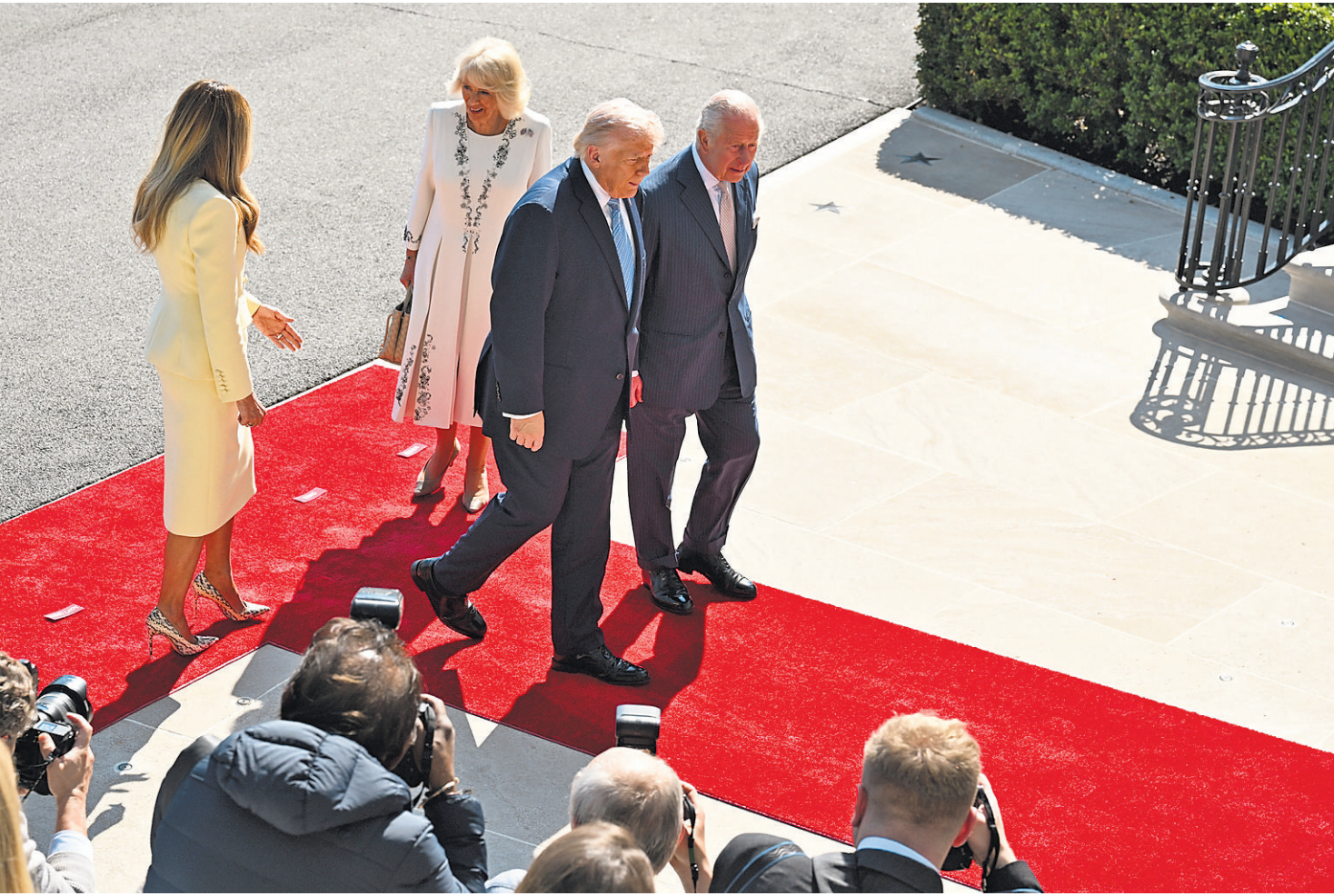
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TUESDAY, APRIL 28, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



KENNY HOLSTON/THE NEW YORK TIMES

A Royal Welcome at the White House
King Charles III and Queen Camilla of Britain met with President Trump and the first lady, Melania Trump, after landing on Monday.

A Google Co-Founder’s Steady Drift to the Right

By **THEODORE SCHLEIFER** and **KATE CONGER**

It was a holiday party at a crypto titan’s estate in Marin County, and Sergey Brin had a bone to pick with Gavin Newsom. Mr. Brin, a Google co-founder and one of the world’s richest people, is a longtime friend of Mr. Newsom, the California governor. Both men attended each other’s weddings. But now Mr. Brin pulled Mr. Newsom aside to a different part of the property for a serious talk.

Mr. Brin told Mr. Newsom that he could not stand the state’s pro-

‘MAGA Girlfriend’ by His Side, Brin Joins Many Tech Peers

Mr. Newsom, who had never seemed inclined to support the tax, came out the next month and pledged to defeat it. He declined to comment on the interaction.

The December confrontation, which took place at a party thrown by the billionaire Chris Larsen and was recounted by three people briefed on it, reflected Mr. Brin’s new war footing. He is growing more politically agitated, more willing to spend his estimated \$273 billion fortune on elections and evidently more receptive to Republican points of view.

Mr. Brin, 52, long showed little

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Warehouses For ICE Face Legal Delays

By **HAMED ALEAZIZ**

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration is scrambling to conduct environmental impact reviews of warehouses it plans to convert into immigrant holding facilities, after a flurry of lawsuits claiming the administration sidestepped federal requirements.

The Immigration and Customs Enforcement agency is buying the warehouses to help it increase the rate of deportations, which depends on having enough space to house detainees. The administration currently has about 58,000 immigrants in custody, and fell short of its target to reach 100,000 beds by the end of last year.

But the plan to buy and retrofit commercial warehouses to accommodate tens of thousands more detainees may be delayed after hitting roadblocks, including opposition from residents and officials in the communities where the warehouses are located. Now, states are trying to block the projects by arguing that the

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Within Rikers, Video Games Serve as an Escape

By **NICOLE CARPENTER**

Talik Thomas spent three days trying to solve a puzzle in the survival horror game Daymare: 1998. In addition to its zombies are the devilishly hard puzzles, one of which requires properly flipping a sequence of switches. It is tricky for a lot of players: Tens of thousands of people have viewed YouTube videos created to help them find the solution.

But inside Rikers Island, the New York jail complex where Mr. Thomas was being held on gun charges, the internet is not freely available. He could not ask Google for help. Instead, he pulled out a notebook to scribble down possible sequences.

“Games like that I do enjoy, because in here, it helps pass the time,” Mr. Thomas, 22, said in an interview at Rikers. “You’re thinking actively, going through different scenarios.”

Video games may seem inconsequential in a place with a reputation for dangerous conditions and inhumane treatment. More than a dozen Rikers inmates died in custody last year, and an independent commission has called the jail complex “a crumbling, inordinately expensive incubator of misery.” (The City Council has ordered the complex’s closure by August 2027, although New York, which plans to replace it with four smaller jails, is unlikely to meet that deadline.)

But for some of the young inmates at Rikers, which houses nearly 7,000 people serving short sentences or awaiting trial, games provide an important sense of normalcy. Mr. Thomas said the pastime — his favorite games are the basketball franchise NBA 2K and the bullet-time shooter Max

Rikers Island in New York uses games as a reward to help reduce violence. Inmates say the pastime makes life seem more normal.

Payne — was a good mental release in jail.

“The environment is very hostile at times,” Mr. Thomas said. “It’s a good way to offset the hostility, so I know I’m still me. I don’t always have to be on edge or on my tippy toes about everything.”

Jesus Thompson, who was incarcerated at Rikers for eight months last year on a charge of attempted criminal possession of a weapon, said video games have always been an important coping mechanism.

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Ballroom Builder Got No-Bid Deal for Nearby Job

This article is by **David A. Fahrenthold, Luke Broadwater and Andrea Fuller**.

WASHINGTON — To build his mammoth White House ballroom, President Trump last summer chose Maryland-based Clark Construction. Since then, Mr. Trump has repeatedly sung the company’s praises, even saying he wanted it to refurbish projects all over Washington.

In January, government documents show, the Trump administration secretly gave the company a no-bid contract to do another job at a sharply inflated price.

The National Park Service wanted to repair two ornamental fountains in Lafayette Park, across Pennsylvania Avenue from the White House. The Biden administration in 2022 had estimated the work would cost \$3.3 million. But Mr. Trump’s government agreed to pay Clark \$11.9 million to do it, and later added tasks that increased the contract to \$17.4 million, the documents show.

The agency did so without con-

Repairs at Lafayette Park, near the White House. The project, once estimated at \$3.3 million, now has a \$17.4 million budget.

sidering offers from other firms, citing a rarely used “urgency” exception to normal open-bidding procedures usually meant for emergencies like war or natural disasters. By law, federal agencies are generally supposed to seek competing bids to find the vendor that provides the best deal.

Unlike the ballroom project, which Mr. Trump says will be funded by private donations, the fountain repairs are being funded by the government.

On Friday, Mr. Trump took credit

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INTERNATIONAL A4-9
That Perfect Mount Fuji Shot
Unruly crowds of visitors have put a picturesque Japanese town on edge. Residents are pushing back. **PAGE A9**

Iran’s Outline for Peace
The country proposed opening the Strait of Hormuz to shipping traffic and the U.S. lifting its blockade. **PAGE A6**

NATIONAL A10-17, 20
The Life Behind a Narrative
President Trump posted footage of an immigrant’s killing by another immigrant to push his agenda, but the actual story was more nuanced. **PAGE A10**

Exodus of Black Republicans
All four members in the House are retiring, erasing diversity gains in the G.O.P. ranks of Congress. **PAGE A14**

SPORTS B6-10
A Boundary-Breaking Race
Ideal conditions, teamwork and shoes combined to yield record-smashing times at the London Marathon. **PAGE B7**



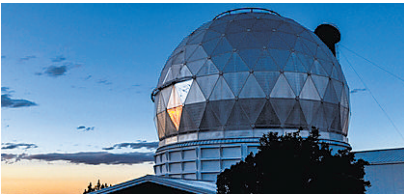
ARTS C1-6
Live, Die and Reprise
A musical adaptation of the 1987 film “The Lost Boys” is an over-the-top spectacle, until its second half. **PAGE C1**

‘Michael’ Gets Them Moving
Critics have savaged the biopic about the star, but fans were dancing in the aisles on its opening weekend. **PAGE C1**

BUSINESS B1-5
Children? Can’t Afford Them.
High mortgage payments, higher child care costs and economic uncertainty are making some people rethink their plans on starting a family. **PAGE B1**

OBITUARIES B11-12
An Artistic Ascetic
Aldwyth made collages and Joseph Cornell-like contraptions that told stories about art history and her place in it. She was 90. **PAGE B12**

OPINION A18-19
Frank Bruni **PAGE A19**



SCIENCE TIMES D1-8
Dark Sky and Dark Energy
In a remote part of Texas, the McDonald Observatory offers a portal to the early universe, enabled by the Earth’s largest dark-sky reserve. **PAGE D1**

